

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Verizon plans to cut** roughly 15,000 jobs, looking to reduce costs as it contends with increased competition for wireless service and home-internet customers. **A1**
- ◆ **Investor worries about** valuations and Fed policy helped to depress major U.S. stock indexes, with the S&P 500 and Dow each falling 1.7% and the Nasdaq losing 2.3%. **B1**
- ◆ **Paramount, Comcast** and Netflix, up against a Nov. 20 deadline for nonbinding offers, are preparing bids for Warner Bros. Discovery. **B1**
- ◆ **Shares of Disney fell** nearly 8% as efforts to turn around a yearslong stock slump with growth in its streaming and experiences businesses failed to impress investors. **B1**
- ◆ **Cursor, which makes** an AI coding tool favored by engineers, raised \$2.3 billion in a funding round that raised the startup's valuation to \$29.3 billion. **B1**
- ◆ **Blue Origin launched** its massive orbital rocket, the first time the vehicle is carrying cargo for a customer and its second mission overall. **B3**
- ◆ **Robinhood clients can** have cash from their accounts delivered to their door for a fee under an agreement between the brokerage firm and Gopuff. **B1**
- ◆ **NBCUniversal is adding** to its mix of sports offerings by launching a cable channel called NBCSN that Google's YouTube TV has already agreed to carry. **B4**
- ◆ **Boeing's unionized machinists** ratified a new collective-bargaining agreement, ending a nearly 15-week strike. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **China's state-sponsored** hackers used artificial-intelligence technology from Anthropic to automate break-ins of major corporations and foreign governments during a September hacking campaign, the company said. **A1**
- ◆ **With the reopening** of the federal government the return to normal is expected to come relatively quickly, though mountains of work await federal workers. **A4**
- ◆ **Workers will be able** to put up to \$24,500 into their 401(k)s and similar workplace retirement accounts in 2026, up \$1,000 from this year, the IRS said. **A2**
- ◆ **A judge said she** expected to issue a ruling before Thanksgiving on the legitimacy of the appointment of the U.S. attorney prosecuting two of Trump's perceived adversaries. **A3**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** sued California over its new congressional map adding five Democratic-leaning districts for the 2026 midterm elections. **A3**
- ◆ **Amazon.com joined** Microsoft in supporting legislation that threatens to further limit Nvidia's ability to export to China. **A6**
- ◆ **Customs and Border Protection** personnel are headed to Charlotte, N.C., a local sheriff's office said, making it the latest Democratic-led city to receive an influx of federal agents. **A3**
- ◆ **Israeli settlers torched** and defaced a mosque in the town of Deir Istiya in the West Bank a day after some Israeli leaders condemned a recent attack by settlers against Palestinians. **A8**

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Things Are Looking Up as Government Reopens



CAPITOL VENTURE: A tour group gazed at the Capitol rotunda on Thursday as the 43-day government shutdown ended. Many Washington attractions relying on federal funding are reopening while furloughed staff are returning to work. **A4**

Chinese Hackers Automated Attacks Using Anthropic's AI

September campaign needed little human interaction, boosting its speed and scale

By SAM SCHECHNER AND ROBERT McMILLAN

China's state-sponsored hackers used artificial intelligence technology from Anthropic to automate break-ins of major corporations and foreign governments during a September hacking campaign, the company said Thursday.

The effort focused on dozens of targets and involved a level of automation that Anthropic's cybersecurity investigators had not previously seen, according to Jacob Klein, the company's head of threat intelligence.

Hackers have been using AI for years now to conduct individual tasks such as crafting phishing emails or scanning the internet for vulnerable systems, but in this instance 80% to 90% of the attack was automated, with humans only intervening in a handful of decision points, Klein said.

The hackers conducted their attacks "literally with the click of a button, and then with minimal human interaction," Klein said. Anthropic disrupted the campaigns and

blocked the hackers' accounts, but not before as many as four intrusions were successful. In one case, the hackers directed Anthropic's Claude AI tools to query internal databases and extract data independently.

"The human was only involved in a few critical chokepoints, saying, 'Yes, continue,' 'Don't continue,' 'Thank you for this information,' 'Oh, that doesn't look right, Claude, are you sure?'"

Stitching together hacking tasks into nearly autonomous attacks is a new step in a growing trend of automation that is giving hackers additional scale and speed.

This summer, the cyberse-

curity firm Volexity spotted China-backed hackers using AI tools to automate parts of a hacking campaign against corporations, research institutions and nongovernmental agencies.

The hackers were using large language models to determine who they should target, how to craft their phishing emails and how to write the malicious software they used to infect their victims, said Steven Adair, Volexity's president. "AI is empowering the threat actor to do more, quicker," he said.

Last week, Google reported that hackers linked to the Russian government attacked

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Verizon Plans To Cut Workforce By 15%

New CEO seeks big cost reductions after board soured on predecessor

Verizon Communications plans to cut about 15,000 jobs—the largest ever for the carrier, which is looking to reduce costs as it contends with increased competition for customers, according to people familiar with the matter.

By Emily Glazer, Suzanne Vranica and Patricia Haggin

The move comes after Verizon last month ousted its chief executive, Hans Vestberg, and named its lead independent director Daniel Schulman as its new CEO.

Schulman, a former CEO of PayPal and Virgin Mobile USA, has said he would aggressively reduce the company's costs and take steps to reverse the customer losses. "Verizon is at a critical inflection point," he said last month.

The cuts are set to take place in the next week, the people said. The majority of the reduction is expected to be made through layoffs. Verizon also plans to transition about 200 stores into franchised operations, which will shift employees off its payroll, one of the people said. Verizon currently employs about 100,000 people.

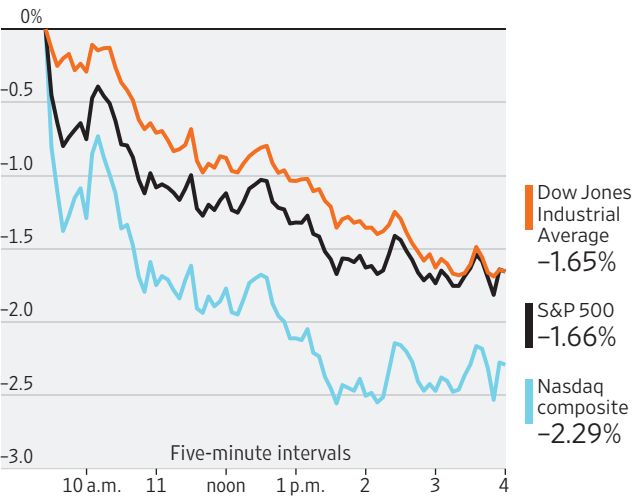
The leadership change, announced in early October, was abrupt for a company that had conducted a multiyear horse race before appointing Vestberg. Before he was elevated, there were only two other men who had served as sole CEO since the company

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Rally Unwinds on Tech Fears

U.S. stocks posted their worst day in a month. Declines were broad, with tech stocks sliding alongside the Dow industrials. **B1**

Index performance on Thursday



Source: FactSet

The Biggest Diva in Hollywood Is a Camera

Resurgence of an old-timey film format creates headaches on sets; 'She was moody'

By JOHN JURGENSEN

Actors Jesse Plemons and Emma Stone were facing off in a crucial moment of their new movie "Bugonia." Over a tense meal, a conspiracy-crazed kidnapper presses his hostage to admit she's an alien in disguise.

That's when another participant in the scene threw a fit, spoiling the take and causing panic in the crew. Wilma had quit again.

"Wilma" was a nickname on set for the Wilcam-11, a vintage camera drafted into service for a film format that'd been obsolete for a half-century. This technological fossil

produced rich portraits of the "Bugonia" characters for the big screen, but behaved like a diva behind the scenes.

"She was moody," Stone says. "She knew she was gorgeous, so she did what she wanted."

The camera gobbled costly film stock at twice the speed of conventional analog cameras. It required rolls of film that were the size of pizzas but only delivered 10 minutes of footage each and took five to change.

"Quiet on the set" didn't apply to the sound of the camera's old-timey chatter—when it was working. Its motorized innards were prone to skidding, seizing

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It's Easier to Rob a Museum Than a French Jewelry Store

It's not just the Louvre. Minimal security and the high price of gold have fueled nine heists over the past year.

Barely 24 hours had passed since thieves had broken into the Louvre Museum and stolen France's crown jewels when the mayor of Langres, a walled medieval town in Eastern France, received a troubling phone call.

By Noemie Bisserbe, Stacy Meichtry and Bertrand Benoit

The director of the town's museum was on the line to report that it too had been robbed. Thieves had penetrated the Maison des Lumières Denis Diderot overnight and gone straight for a display case housing its collection of historic gold and silver coins.

"It's as if the city's jewels have been stolen," said Pierrick White, the mayor's chief of staff.

The brazen robbery of the Louvre on Oct. 19 grabbed the world's attention, because it targeted an iconic institution and a nation's crown jewels. But the Louvre robbery was just one of nine different heists that have taken place in France over the past year.

Six French museums have been hit since the beginning of September alone—one of them twice—including at the stately Museum of Natural History in central Paris and the Musée du Désert, located in a remote hamlet

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INSIDE



SPORTS
The Big Ten, the SEC and the battle over the future of college football. **A12**

MANSION
They planned for retirement—then disasters destroyed their homes. **M1**

Prospects Get Gloomier For New College Grads

By LINDSAY ELLIS

Employers have a warning for the Class of 2026: Next spring's graduate-hiring market is likely to be even worse than this year's.

Six months out from graduation season, more than half of 183 employers surveyed by the National Association of Colleges and Employers rate the job market for the Class of 2026 as poor or fair. That is the most pessimistic outlook since the first year of the pandemic, according to the survey, which is widely seen as an early signal of graduate hiring each year.

A cooling job market is darkening that outlook. In recent months, employers from Amazon.com to United Parcel Service have revealed plans to

cut thousands of jobs. The latest is Verizon Communications, which, according to people familiar with the matter, plans to cut 15,000 jobs over the next week in its largest reduction ever.

Companies say the uncertain economic outlook has pushed them to hire more conservatively, and many are giving priority to recruits with some experience as opposed to those fresh from college. More executives are also speaking openly about the potential of artificial intelligence to bring deep job cuts and take over more tasks that new graduates are traditionally tapped to perform.

For college seniors, that means also competing against junior workers who have been

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